

Curriculum Vitae: Haixia Gu (古海霞)

Nationality: Chinese

Sex: Female

Date of Birth: February 1996

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Research Area

With an interdisciplinary background in psychology and genetics, my research focuses on the genetic basis of psychosocial stress and its genetic and potential causal relationships with psychiatric disorders and other complex traits.

Education

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| 2022.09-present | School of Life Science, Central South University
Ph.D. in Genetics
Expected completion: Dec 2026
Supervisors: Chao Chen & Chunyu Liu |
| 2024.11-2026.07 | Interdisciplinary Center Psychopathology and Emotion Regulation (ICPE),
Department of Psychiatry, University Medical Center Groningen, University
of Groningen
Joint Ph.D. student
Supervisors: Catharina Hartman & Harold Snieder |
| 2019.09-2022.07 | School of Psychology, Shaanxi Normal University
Degree: M.S. in Basic Psychology
Supervisors: Jingjing Zhao & Chunyu Liu |
| 2015.09-2019.07 | School of Public Health and Management, Chongqing Medical University
Degree: B.S. in Applied Psychology |

Research Projects (Lead Researcher)

- 1. GWAS Meta-analysis of Stressful Life Events in Over 500,000 Europeans**
 - **Status:** Completed; Manuscript in preparation; [Conference abstract published](#).
 - Identified 13 genetic loci associated with stressful life events and investigated their genetic correlations and potential causal relationships with neuropsychiatric and cardiometabolic disorders.
- 2. Polygenic Risk for Stressful Life Event Exposure in Relation to Cumulative Stressful Life Events and Health: A Longitudinal Study in the NESDA Cohort**
 - **Status:** Completed; Manuscript in preparation.
 - Investigated associations between polygenic risk for stressful life events and longitudinal trajectories of stress exposure and mental and physical health outcomes.
- 3. Unified Definition of Psychological Stress and the Cognitive Integration Model**
 - **Status:** Completed; Manuscript in preparation.
 - Proposed a unified definition of psychological stress and a Cognitive Integration Model that specifies the stress-generation and stress-handling processes.

4. Preliminary Development and Validation of the Multidimensional Integrated Stress Scale (MISS) in Chinese Adults

- **Status:** Completed; Manuscript in preparation.
- Developed the Chinese version of the Multidimensional Integrated Stress Scale (MISS) based on the Cognitive Integration Model and conducted preliminary assessments of its reliability and validity.

Publications

- **Gu, H.,** Lei, Y., Yao, Y., Chen, C.* & Liu, C.* 2025. Physiological and psychological responses to acute stress: A meta-analysis of the 171 studies of Trier Social Stress Test including 8452 healthy adults. *Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 107566. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.psyneuen.2025.107566>.
- **Gu, H.,** Lei, Y., Zhang, Y., Chen, C.* & Liu, C.* 2026. Unified Definition of Psychological Stress and the Cognitive Integration Model. Preprints. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/9a6p4_v1.
- Lei, Y., **Gu, H.,** Yang, Q., Xu, Z., Liu, C.* 2026. Basic Psychological Need Satisfaction and Frustration in the Association Between Childhood Maltreatment and Adult Stress Response: A Cross-Sectional Study of Chinese Adults. Preprints. <https://doi.org/10.20944/preprints202609.2520.v1>.
- Xu, S., Min, S., **Gu, H.,** Wang, X., Chen, C.* 2025. A comprehensive guide to genome-wide DNA methylation research in neuropsychiatric disorders and its implications for deep-space environment. *Journal of Central South University. Medical Science*, 50(8): 1320-1336. <https://doi.org/10.11817/j.issn.1672-7347.2025.250387>.
- Zhang, W., Yin, X., **Gu, H.,** Huang, S., Chen, C.* 2024. Advancements and prospects in human organoid phenomics: a comprehensive review (in Chinese: 人源类器官表型组学的研究进展及展望). *Sci Sin Vitae*, 54: 2125-2142. <https://doi.org/10.1360/SSV-2024-0113>
- **Gu, H.,** Ma, X. E., Zhao, J., & Liu, C.* 2022. A Meta-Analysis of Salivary Cortisol Responses in the Trier Social Stress Test to Evaluate the Effects of Speech Topics, Sex, and Sample Size. *Comprehensive Psychoneuroendocrinology*, 10, 100125. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cpnec.2022.100125>.
- Ma, X. E., **Gu, H.,** & Zhao, J.* 2021. Atypical Gaze Patterns to Facial Feature Areas in Autism Spectrum Disorders Reveal Age and Culture Effects: A Meta-Analysis of Eye-Tracking Studies. *Autism Research*. 14(12), 2625-2639. <https://doi.org/10.1002/aur.2607>.
- Zhang, M., Sun, Y., **Gu, H.,** & Jiang, J.* 2018. The Neural Mechanism of Communication Ability of Autistic Children and the Research and Application of Picture Exchange Communication System. *Advances in Social Sciences*. 7(11): 1802-1809. <https://doi.org/10.12677/ASS.2018.711267>.

Academic Conferences

- GWAS meta-analysis in more than 500,000 Europeans identifies 10 loci for stressful life events and shows causal links with neuropsychiatric and cardiometabolic disorders. *World Congress of Psychiatric Genetics (WCPG)*, Glasgow, Scotland, October 2026. [Poster]
- GWAS meta-analysis in more than 500,000 Europeans identifies genetic loci for stressful life events and their causal links with neuropsychiatric and cardiometabolic disorders. *Behavior Genetics Association (BGA) Annual Meeting*, Amsterdam, Netherlands, 2026. [Oral]

- Psychological Stress as a Phenotype: Updated Definition and Quantification. *4th International Symposium of Human Phenomics and 5th Human Phenomics Conference of China*, Shanghai, China, November 2023. [Poster]
- Psychological Stress as a Phenotype: Updated Definition and Quantification. *Academic Annual Meeting of the Behavioral Genetics Branch of the Chinese Genetics Society and 9th Academic Forum on Psychiatric Genetics – Young Scholars Forum*, Changsha, China, 2023. [Oral]
- A New High-Throughput Method to Induce Robust Psychological Stress. *60th Annual Meeting of the American College of Neuropsychopharmacology (ACNP)*, San Juan, Puerto Rico, 2021. [Poster]
- The Trier Social Stress Test-Electronic Screen (TSST-ES) Induces Acute Stress Responses Efficiently. *23rd National Conference of Psychology*, Fujian, China, 2021. [Oral]

Honors and Awards

Academic Scholarships

- **President's Scholarship (Innovation Award)**, Central South University, 2025.
- **China Scholarship Council (CSC) Scholarship for Visiting PhD Students**, 2023 (24 months).
- **First-Class Academic Scholarship**, Central South University, 2022, 2025.
- **Second-Class Academic Scholarship**, Central South University, 2023, 2024.
- **First-Class Academic Scholarship**, Shaanxi Normal University, 2022.
- **Second-Class Academic Scholarship**, Shaanxi Normal University, 2019.
- **National Encouragement Scholarship**, Chongqing Education Commission, 2016, 2017, 2018.

Research and Presentation Awards

- **Outstanding Poster Award**, 4th International Symposium of Human Phenomics and 5th Human Phenomics Conference of China, 2023.
- **Excellence Award**, Academic Annual Meeting of the Behavioral Genetics Branch of the Chinese Genetics Society and 9th Academic Forum on Psychiatric Genetics – Young Scholars Forum, 2023.
- **Excellent Paper Nomination Award**, 6th National Symposium on Emotional and Health Psychology, 2021.

Research Skills

Genetics & Genomics

- Statistical Genetics: GWAS, PheWAS, Mendelian randomization (MR), polygenic risk scores (PRS).
- Functional Genomics & Epigenetics: eQTL analysis, DNA methylation analysis.
- Molecular Biology: DNA/RNA extraction, ELISA.

Psychology & Neuroscience

- Neuroimaging & Electrophysiology: fMRI, event-related potentials (ERP).
- Psychological Assessment & Intervention: Cognitive behavioral therapy (CBT), sandplay therapy.

Languages

- Chinese; English.

Updated date: October 2026